

25 June 2026

Re: Shipment CAHC-0421

Hi all,

Shipment CAHC-0421 is on its way — brain, CSF and plasma from our contact-sport cohort. The inventory workbook has one tab per sample type. Jorge's notes tab covers the freezer incident and the units question, so I won't repeat him.

Two things from me that aren't in the workbook.

First, the highlighting. Rows shaded amber failed our internal QC — most often prolonged time-to-freeze, in a couple of cases visible degradation on receipt. We've shipped them because you asked for everything we had, but I would not build an analysis on them. There is no legend in the file; the colour is the only record we keep, which I appreciate is not ideal.

Second, and more importantly: our CTE-negative subjects are not really controls. They come from a separate concussion-surveillance study with quite different inclusion criteria — younger, recruited while still competing, and screened for symptoms rather than sampled at autopsy. We list them alongside our cases because that is how our database is structured, but pooling them as though they were a matched control group would be a mistake. If you need proper controls I'd look elsewhere.

Shout if anything arrives broken.

Best,



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